

FLIPDIGIT 1” CONTROLLER

MANUAL DISPLAY PROGRAMMING SOFTWARE

Attention: Please read the manual carefully.

**In case of any doubts or questions pls contact
Marcin Krynski at info@alfazeta.pl or +48 42 6891200,**

Please note that Poland is GMT+1

Rev. 2 / 30 AUG 2016



Alfa-Zeta Co. Ltd.
ul. Starorudzka 6a
93-418 Łódź
POLAND



tel. +48 42 689 12 00
tel. +48 42 689 12 01
tel. +48 42 689 12 02
fax +48 42 689 12 03



<http://www.alfazeta.pl>
<http://www.flipdots.com>
<http://www.swiatlowody.com>
<http://led.alfazeta.pl>

info@alfazeta.pl
info@flipdots.com
info@swiatlowody.com
info@alfazeta.pl

corporate website
visual information displays
fiber optic lighting
LED lighting

Technical data

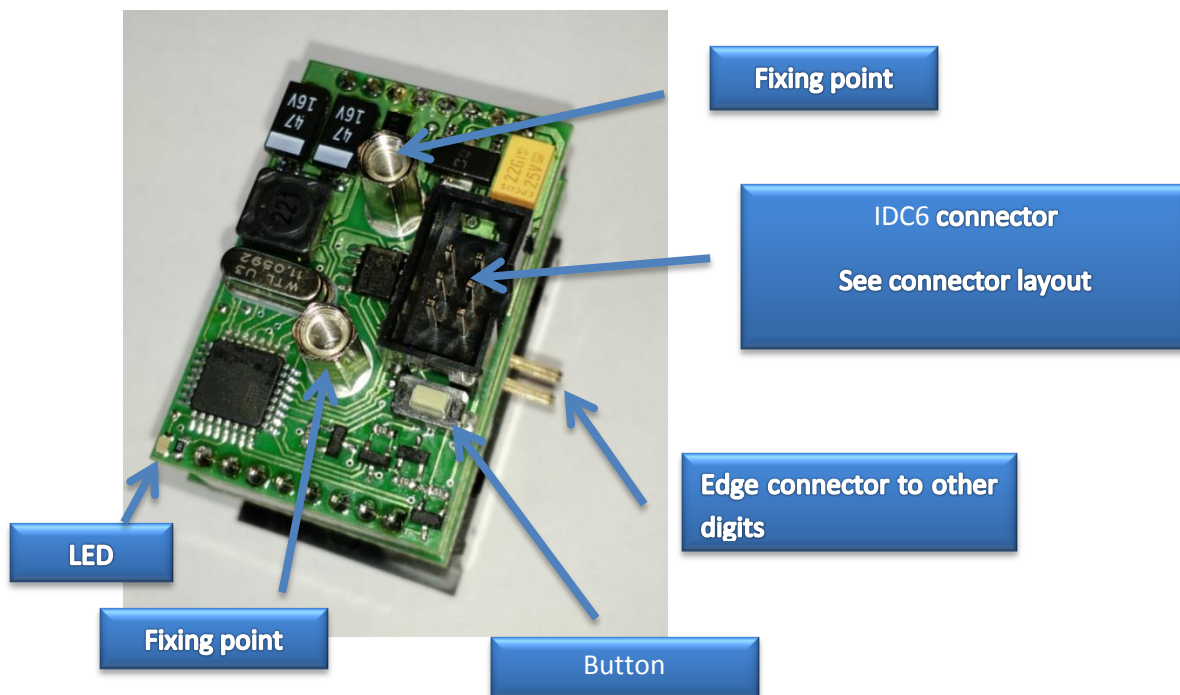
Supply voltage

19V DC - 24V DC

Control interface

RS485

ALFAZETA General layout



General info

The controller is built to drive one 1" small seven segment module. It is using RS485 to communicate a master unit which can be any rs485 data sending device (a PC with RS485 interface, Arduino, Raspberry Pi, etc) Each digit has got its own unique address and communication speed. In order to set these parameters you need to use a protocol described below or use a dedicated software.

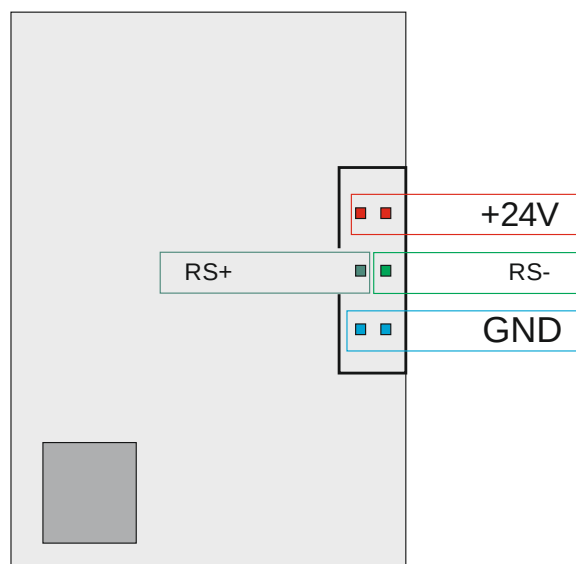
Address is a number 0 – 255, when 255 is co called 'broadcast' address at which all digits would receive data. Therefore it is strongly advised to use only 0 – 254 (0x00 – 0xFE) addresses for digits.

Possible communications speeds are:

1. 1200 bit/s
2. 2400 bit/s
3. 4800 bit/s
4. 9600 bit/s
5. 19200 bit/s
6. 38400 bit/s
7. 57600 bit/s
8. 115200 bit/s

A center IDC6 connector is used to combine a number of strips into one network using ribbon cables which carry in one cable both power supply and data.

IDC6 connector layout



Protocol

Frame structure

Header	command	Address	Data	End byte
0x80	Description below	0x00 – 0xFF	Description below	0x8F

Data:

- MSB is neglected, the following bits B6 – B0 are setting dots from top to bottom respectively.

Commands:

Command	Number of data bytes	Automatic refresh	Description
0x89	1	Yes	Send one data byte and show it in the display



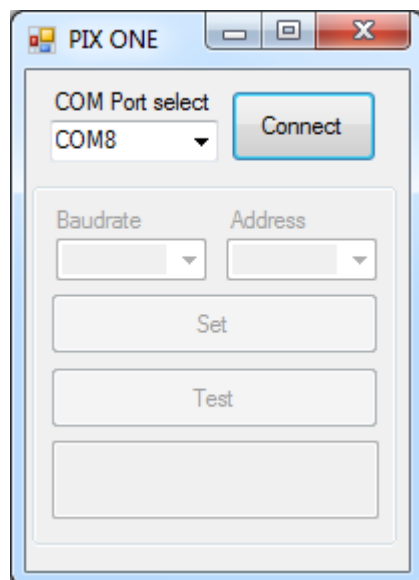
0x8A	1	NO	Send one data byte and wait for refresh
0x8B	1	-	Set RS speed: 0x00 – 1200bit/s 0x01 – 2400bit/s 0x02 – 4800bit/s 0x03 – 9600bit/s 0x04 – 19200bit/s 0x05 – 38400bit/s 0x06 – 57600bit/s 0x07 – 115200bit/s
0x8C	1	-	Set address 0x00 – 0xFE (0xFF broadcast)
0xC0	0	-	Format 0x80, 0xC0, 0x8F – request for address, response – 0xAA, 0xCC, [address]

Test mode

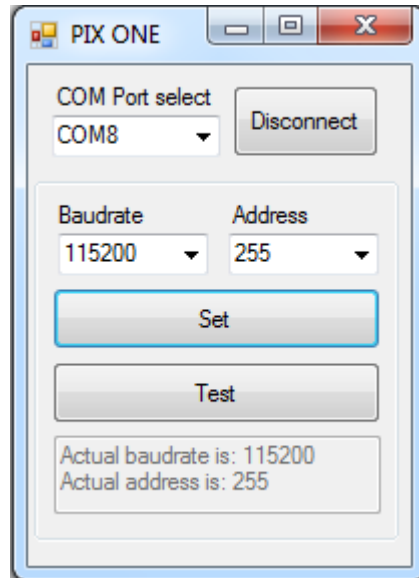
In order to start test mode, the controller has to be powered with button pressed. Connected digit will show number 0 – 9 until it is repowered.

Programming

In order to simplify address / speed settings we offer a small app (see qr code and link on teh next page):



After selection of COM port and choosing 'connect', this software will show current speed and address.



'Set' button is used to send data from 'Baud rate' and 'Address' fields.

After successful programming, new values are being shown in a window in a lower part of the window.

'Test' button allows to show a sample sequence on a strip.

You can program only one digit at a time.

Fixing points

Two fixing tubes M3.

